

# Measures Setting: Potential Indicators and Pathways



Measure setting is the process of establishing regulatory controls and conservation tools that govern how, when, where, and how much fish can be harvested to prevent overfishing and ensure the long-term sustainability of stocks. Measures could include regulations such as effort controls, spatial or temporal closures, or size and age limits to landings. **Note:** measure setting also includes regulating catch limits, however due to the importance of catch management decisions, catch and quota setting are described in their own 1-pager.

- **Key question:** What additional indicators could inform measures setting? Could ecosystem indicators or recreational demand indicators in addition to current information improve the process?
- **Scope:** Should we develop a general process for using indicators in the measures setting process, or focus on a specific application for a single species? Which species?

## What information is used now?

Current measures in place are outlined by NOAA's [Specification Summaries](#) and their [Federal Regulations](#).

## Information sources for indicators

Big picture performance metrics for commercial and recreational fisheries are available in:

- [State of the Ecosystem Reports](#)
- [EAFM Risk Assessments](#)
- [Ecosystem and Socioeconomic Profiles](#)

Also see [river herring](#) bycatch mitigation IRA project

## Information gaps

To understand multispecies, multifleet implications of measures set for a given species, we would need easy access to:

- What fleets the species is caught in.
  - [CAMS](#) data for commercial fleets
  - [MRIP](#) for recreational fleets
- Other targets and catch from these fleets
- Who manages the other species and fleets if not MAFMC
- Measures in place for all the other species (commercial and recreational) caught with the species of interest

## Further useful information could include:

- Aggregate performance metrics for the fisheries to evaluate implications of changes (commercial and recreational):
  - Landings
  - Revenues
  - Trips
  - Expenditures
  - Resilience
  - Other system level fishery elements from risk assessment
- Stock projections of age and size compositions
- Projections of commercial fleet and angler response to measures
  - Is there a threshold for switching to a different species?
- Projections of climate and habitat conditions for relevant species
  - See [Changing Ecosystems and Fisheries Initiative Portal](#)